

PLATE I

IF a certain fabric has been selected for cross-stitch work, say Java canvas for a scarf, for instance, then a design suitable for a scarf and suitable in size for this particular material must be selected. The basket of blue and orange flowers in the middle of the opposite page is fifty-three spaces wide. By using two threads of the canvas for each stitch fifty-three spaces would measure between seven and eight inches, and this would allow two baskets to fit nicely across the end of the scarf. If this same design were used on Mosaic canvas, it would occupy a space about twelve inches wide and would do nicely for a pillow top. If made on Hardanger cloth or fine scrim it would measure only about two inches and would make a pretty little pincushion or bag. This simply goes to show that the mesh of the canvas regulates the size of the design when worked.

If it is desirable to make the design larger, there are two ways of accomplishing this, either take the stitches across two or three or more threads of the fabric, or make four crosses instead of the one shown on the pattern. Even nine crosses may be made for each one of the pattern, thus increasing the size of the design three times in both dimensions. Of course the size of the thread used determines which is the better plan to follow.

Before commencing any cross-stitch piece, count the number of spaces occupied by the design, then count the same number of spaces on the fabric and mark off exactly how large the pattern will be when worked.

The rose tree at the top of the page is very pretty for the bottom of portières made of burlap, monk's cloth, or some similar heavy fabric. This may be enlarged to any desired size by increasing the number of crosses, and a quite heavy thread is recommended for this particular purpose. To the right of the tree the little star and cross border appears, or at least, the two motifs are intended for a border to be made by repeating the spots at regular intervals. If a more solid effect is desired, place a straight continuous line of crosses on both sides of the motifs. This makes a pretty band for trimming children's dresses and aprons and it is effective in one or two colors.

At the upper right corner is a dainty basket of flowers made on the diagonal. This is a quaint, old-fashioned design which is delightfully pleasing on the corners of a tea-cloth and which may also be used on the napkins by taking smaller stitches. It is also suitable for ornamenting a square centrepiece, and is pretty on a bureau-scarf and a square pincushion.

The cornucopia, which represents or suggests "plenty," is a suitable little spot for a napkin corner, or can be used as a border on the end of a sideboard-cover. The other baskets and trees on the page will find their proper uses either as repeating borders on towels, scarfs, and other household articles, or as separate motifs on bags, dainty little pincushions and handkerchief-cases.

The blue and green flower border at the bottom of the page has numberless possibilities both in form adaptation and color schemes. It is dainty for a curtain border, pillow, dress trimming, and any other purpose for which a straight band can be used. It is even effective in a single color and is varied enough in form not to be at all tiresome.



PLATE I